

Majid Mumtaz CIA, ACA, FCCA

Internal Audit & Risk Leadership | F&B · Hospitality · FMCG · Retail · Family Conglomerates
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Director of Internal Audit with 20 years closing the gap between stated governance and actual operational exposure across F&B, hospitality, FMCG, retail, and family conglomerates in the GCC and Pakistan. CAE at Kitopi through its pre-IPO phase and Group Director of Internal Audit and Risk at Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC), Riyadh, where the audit function achieved IIA 'Generally Conforms', the highest external quality rating. Built Python population-testing infrastructure that replaced sample-based testing with 100% coverage, recovered and protected AED 7.7M in billing and commercial exposure invisible to the executive team, identified SAR 15M in M&A risk before close, and reduced fraud losses 78-82% through predictive monitoring that scaled against a 340% transaction volume increase without adding headcount. Published across IIA Internal Auditor Magazine, GRC Report, Consultancy ME, and Corporate Compliance Insights.

Markets: UAE · KSA · Qatar · Pakistan | External Rating: IIA 'Generally Conforms'

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Veritux Consulting Network | Dubai, UAE

Principal – Internal Audit & Risk Advisory | Jul 2025 – Present

Identifying and closing governance and operational risk gaps for boards and senior leadership: concurrent engagements in UAE and KSA.

- **UAE Real Estate Developer:** Designed and implemented a risk-based internal audit framework, establishing the controls infrastructure required for sustained **RERA regulatory authorisation** and reducing exposure to enforcement risk.
- **Saudi Family Office:** Constructed audit committee governance from foundation: board charters, risk oversight protocols, and reporting structures meeting **Saudi CMA Corporate Governance Regulations**, providing the governance framework required for future capital market activity.

Kitopi (Cloud Kitchen Technology Company) | Dubai, UAE

Director of Internal Audit | Jun 2022 – May 2025

- **SOX 404 ICFR:** Built Kitopi's ICFR programme from zero for its pre-IPO trajectory. EY performed an independent external readiness attestation on a technology-heavy cloud kitchen operation with no SOX history: no material weaknesses, no significant deficiencies.
- **Aggregator Billing Controls:** Identified **AED 3.2M in recoverable billing overcharges** and closed the control gap responsible for **AED 4.5M in future exposure** through an automated continuous monitoring suite.
- **Audit Intelligence Platform:** Designed and deployed a Python/Pandas population testing engine that replaced sample-based testing with 100% transaction coverage across 7 audit domains, Board approved enterprise-wide deployment, converting the audit function from a cost centre into a commercial intelligence asset.
- **Fraud Detection:** Reduced fraud incidents **78%** against a **340% transaction volume increase** through automated exception reporting and predictive transaction monitoring.
- **IPO Governance:** Appointed to IPO Steering Committee as IA representative, cross-functional governance oversight across the full pre-IPO track. Built the audit and IT security assurance team from inception to support the programme (3 auditors, 2 IT security professionals).

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC) | Riyadh, KSA (Diversified Saudi conglomerate: hospitality, retail, real estate and FMCG)

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk | Nov 2016 – May 2022

(Audit Committee Member, AFG Restaurants Sector | Feb 2021 – May 2022)

- **M&A Due Diligence:** Conducted in-house due diligence on a \$127M acquisition, identified SAR 15M in previously undisclosed litigation exposure, enabling renegotiation before close.
- **ERM Architecture:** Designed and deployed a Board-commissioned risk intelligence framework across a four-sector conglomerate (hospitality, retail, real estate, FMCG), giving the Audit Committee its first consolidated view of cross-portfolio exposure across sectors that previously operated independently.
- **Fraud Analytics:** Reduced fraud losses **82%** and recovered **SAR 4.2M annually** through predictive monitoring of high-risk supplier and procurement payments.
- **Function Architecture:** Scaled the audit function from 3 to 20 professionals across four sectors and 10+ GCC markets; externally rated IIA 'Generally Conforms', the highest quality rating.

EARLIER CAREER & BIG 4 FOUNDATION

Manager, Internal Audit | McDonald's Saudi Arabia | Mar 2014 – Oct 2016

Internal Audit Manager | KPMG (Qatar) | Apr 2011 – Dec 2013

AVP, Internal Audit | BMA Asset Management (Karachi-based asset management firm) | Mar 2010 – Apr 2011

Audit Manager | Ernst & Young | Karachi, Pakistan | Dec 2004 – Oct 2009

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS (2026)

- *"Time to rethink risk registers," AB Magazine (ACCA), 2026*
- *"FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances About How Bribery Works in the Persian Gulf," Corporate Compliance Insights*
- *"AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability," GRC Report*
- *"The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing," GRC Report*
- *"The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy: When AI Models Age Faster Than Evolving Fraud," Consultancy ME*
- *"Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags," IIA Internal Auditor Magazine (Voices)*

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Professional Education and Degrees:

- Certified Internal Auditor (CIA, IIA)
- Associate Chartered Accountant (ACA, ICAEW)
- Fellow Chartered Certified Accountant (FCCA, ACCA)
- Bachelor of Commerce (Karachi University)

Executive Education:

- Certificate in Disruptive Strategy (Harvard Business School Online)
- Enterprise Risk Management Certificate (COSO)
- Information Systems Auditing & IT Governance — Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)
- Machine Learning with Python — IBM
- Forensic Accounting and Fraud Examination — West Virginia University (WVU)
- Risk Management Specialization — New York Institute of Finance (NYIF)